

Present success, future tense?

Apple Computer's digital music service, iTunes Music Store sold 2,75,000 music tracks in the first 18 hours. The songs, including videos from Eminem, Bob Dylan, Sting and others, can be previewed for free as 30 second samples. All numbers can be copied to a CD and are automatically synched to an Apple iPod.



According to Billboard magazine, the retailer gets around 36.7 per cent of the price of a normal music CD. Forbes magazine says that Apple takes on 35 per cent for each track it sells.

Apple plans to make iTunes compatible with PCs by the end of the year with its upcoming Win-

dows version of Music Store.

iTunes 4 has a Music Sharing feature that allows people to share music over the LAN. The music is not downloaded permanently but it can be heard as streaming audio. Many programmers have found a way to extend this feature from LAN to the Internet. They have developed software that allows people to search Net-connected Mac's in order to listen to songs online.

New, improved pop-up ads!

Brian Shuster, a long time figure in the Internet pornography world, has recently received the patent for an advertisement format. Shuster's patent—the Traffic Management Utility—claims that pop-up ads account for 20 percent of the revenue of the two most profitable Internet segments, online casinos and adult entertainment. He has set up Ideaflow Inc., an intellectual property holding firm, to license revenue from sites that use pop-ups and other advertising technology.

Other Shuster patents include similar technology to

take control of a user's computer and send them to unexpected Web sites. One, called 'Method, apparatus and system for directing access,' describes the use of hidden frames to inject Java script onto an user's computer that can be later used to send the browser to another Web site. This technology changes the system's settings and registry, sending the user continuously to a specific site—a porn

site—in Shuster's case. For example, typing in www.hotmail.com instead of <http://www.hotmail.com> will deliver a pop-up porn window, and then send the browser to Hotmail.



Online advertising software vendor, Unicast, is coming up with a 15 second, 300 K online advertisement that fills the entire PC screen.

This ad opens when a user clicks a link to go to another page on the same Web site.

quoteworthy

"The Tablet PC is just a buzzword, nobody is buying it. Market *nahi hai*."

Hirji Patel, Chairman of Allied Computer Industries explains that the Tablet PC is currently a niche product

"We have started to block access to immoral sites, as well as political sites which rudely make fun of religious and political figures in the country."

Iranian deputy post and telecommunications minister Masoud Davari-Nejad. The Iranian government has ordered Internet service providers to block around 15,000 Web sites

"We omitted panels for notebook PCs from this exhibition... they do not yield profit."

A spokesman for Samsung Electronics at the Electronic Display Forum in Tokyo, earlier this month.

tomorrow's technology

Nano a Mano

IBM has built the world's first array of carbon nanotube transistors. These tiny carbon atomic cylinders measure about 10 atoms across, are 500 times smaller than today's transistors and said to be 1,000 times stronger than steel. These findings will help in the making of smaller and hence faster chips. Carbon nan-

otubes may provide an alternative at the time when the physical limits of silicon technology will be reached.

Only semiconducting carbon nanotubes can be used to make transistors—the key component in electrical components and chips. Earlier manufacturing processes caused the semiconducting carbon nanotubes to stick

together in a rope like structure and get overpowered by the metallic nanotubes. This required each tube to be moved and separated individually. The IBM team were able to overcome this using constructive destruction, where only semiconducting nanotubes are produced with the electrical properties useful for making transistors.

snapshot

For the quarter ended **March 1**, online auction site, eBay earned **\$104.2 million**, more than double the **\$47.6 million** it earned last year

Source: Associated Press

■ Microsoft plans to turn MSN's free content services into fee-based subscription services ■ MIT professor comes up with a technique to harness energy from vibration